

ContexAi Research Desk · Sourced via Reuters, CNBC, Business Recorder, Express Tribune, Mettis Global, AGBI, Gulf News, S&P Global, Kitco, SBP & Regulatory Trackers · For the C-Suite & HNW Investor · **V** = verified vs licensed media/official portal · **EST.** = ContexAi desk estimate

KSE-100 V

**180,105**

▼ 0.11% Thu ·  
closed Fri  
(Independence  
Day)

S&P 500 V

▼ 0.2%

Nasdaq -0.3% ·  
Dow -0.2% Fri —  
S&P's 3rd straight  
weekly gain

US 10Y / 2Y V

**4.67 / 4.17**

hawkish hold —  
Warsh

BRENT / WTI V

**\$88.52 / \$82.40**

▲ 1.7% / 1.4% Fri ·  
OPEC+ Sept hike  
live

GOLD V

**\$4,373.50**

+0.53% Fri · silver  
\$64.53

USD/PKR V

**277.65**

interbank · steady,  
markets shut Fri

### 01 Five Things You Need To Know To Start Your Day

#### PSX REOPENS AFTER HOLIDAY

The **KSE-100** resumes trading today unchanged from Thursday's close of 180,104.61, after the Pakistan Stock Exchange stayed shut Friday for the Independence Day holiday; Thursday's session itself closed 206.60 points lower (-0.11%, -0.73% on the week) as profit-taking hit fertiliser and pharmaceutical counters even as oil & gas exploration and cement held firm, with breadth negative (269 decliners vs 197 advancers) on turnover of 891.33 million shares worth Rs36.69bn ([Express Tribune](#), [ProPakistani](#)). Sentiment: range-bound, awaiting fresh cues.

#### WALL STREET COOLS FROM RECORDS

US equities eased back Friday — the **S&P 500** slipped 0.2% to 7,785.76, the **Dow** shed 0.2% to 53,732.41 and the **Nasdaq** fell 0.3% to 26,729.16 — after a preliminary University of Michigan reading showed August consumer sentiment tumbling to 51 from July's 55.2, well below the 55 expected; even so, the S&P notched a third straight weekly gain ([CNBC](#), [TheStreet](#)). Sentiment: cooling, still resilient.

#### WARSH KEEPS HAWKISH TONE

Fed Chair **Kevin Warsh** has held the funds rate at 3.50-3.75% since June but continues to stress a strict 2% inflation target ahead of the September 15-16 FOMC meeting; the 10-year Treasury yield rose 5bp to 4.67% (30-year 5.27%) and the 2-year held near 4.17% on the hawkish rhetoric, even as prediction markets price only a roughly 26% chance of a September hike ([CNBC](#), [Advisor Perspectives](#)). Sentiment: **hawkish undertone**.

#### OPEC+ LOCKS IN SEPT HIKE

**Brent** firmed to \$88.52 (+1.7%) and **WTI** to \$82.40 (+1.4%) Friday as OPEC+'s finalised 188,000 bpd September increase — completing the rollback of 2023's voluntary cuts — failed to fully offset a lingering Middle East risk premium; delegates expect quotas to hold steady through year-end pending the next JMMC review on October 4 ([Iraq Business News](#), [World Oil](#)). Sentiment: **supply normalising, price still firm**.

#### GOLD, SILVER FIRM

Gold rose 0.53% to \$4,373.50/oz and silver gained 0.32% to \$64.53/oz Friday as weaker US retail-sales-adjacent data trimmed Fed-hike odds even as a still-hawkish Warsh Fed and Middle East risk kept haven demand supported ([Kitco](#)). Sentiment: **firmer**.

## 02 Regional Market & Economic Matrix

### A. Local Market — Pakistan Focus

The **KSE-100** enters today's session unchanged from Thursday's close of 180,104.61, after the Pakistan Stock Exchange remained shut Friday for the Independence Day holiday ([ProPakistani](#), [Business Recorder](#)). Thursday's session itself closed 206.60 points lower (-0.11%, -0.73% on the week) as profit-taking hit fertiliser and pharmaceutical counters even as oil & gas exploration and cement held firm; breadth was negative with 269 decliners against 197 advancers (29 unchanged) on turnover of 891.33 million shares worth Rs36.69bn, led by Cnergyico (+4.35%) and Service Industries (+3.91%) among gainers against Systems Ltd (-1.59%) and Engro Holdings (-0.94%) among laggards ([Express Tribune](#)). The **SBP** held its policy rate at 11.5% at its July 27 review for a second straight pause, with July CPI at 9.2% y/y even as food inflation ran hotter at 10.6% ([Business Recorder](#)). Six-month KIBOR stood at roughly 11.51/11.76% as of August 7 ([SBP](#)). The interbank **USD/PKR** was last quoted at 277.65 on Thursday, with banks and the exchange closed Friday for the holiday ([Business Recorder](#)). On the **IMF** front, a mission is due in Islamabad for the fourth EFF review and second RSF review, with roughly \$1.2bn combined — about \$1bn under the EFF and \$200m under the RSF — at stake, with tax collection, energy-sector reforms and privatisation progress under scrutiny ([Energy Update](#)).

### B. GCC & Middle East

OPEC+ has finalised a further 188,000 bpd output increase for September — completing the alliance's unwinding of 2023's voluntary cuts — with delegates signalling quotas will likely hold steady through year-end pending the next JMMC review on October 4 ([Iraq Business News](#), [World Oil](#)). Saudi Arabia's non-oil private sector held expansionary for a fourth straight month, with the Riyadh Bank PMI easing to 53.1 in July from 53.3 in June as domestic demand strengthened even as export orders fell for a fifth consecutive month ([Business Recorder](#)). The **PIF**, chaired by Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, is executing its 2026-2030 strategy across Vision, Strategic and Financial portfolios, prioritising tourism, travel, entertainment and sport — including a July tie-up between SURJ Sports Investment, Live Nation and Oak View Group to launch Radia, and a \$2bn co-investment MoU with I Squared Capital — under **Vision 2030** ([PIF](#)).

### C. Global Intelligence

US equities eased back from record territory Friday — the S&P 500 slipped 0.2% to 7,785.76, the Dow shed 0.2% to 53,732.41 and the Nasdaq Composite fell 0.3% to 26,729.16 — after a preliminary University of Michigan reading showed August consumer sentiment tumbling to 51 from July's 55.2, well below the 55 expected; even so, the S&P notched a third straight weekly gain ([CNBC](#), [TheStreet](#)). The **10-year Treasury yield** rose 5bp to about 4.67% (30-year 5.27%) and the 2-year held near 4.17%, as Fed Chair **Kevin Warsh** kept a hawkish tone on the Fed's strict 2% inflation target ahead of the September 15-16 FOMC meeting, even as prediction markets price roughly a 26% chance of a hike ([Advisor Perspectives](#)). **Brent** and **WTI** firmed to \$88.52 and \$82.40 respectively as OPEC+'s finalised September output hike failed to fully offset a lingering Middle East risk premium ([Trading Economics](#)). Gold and silver advanced to \$4,373.50/oz (+0.53%) and \$64.53/oz (+0.32%) as haven demand held firm against the still-hawkish Fed backdrop ([Kitco](#)).

### 03 Legislative & Regulatory Tracker — Who Wins, Who Loses

| Jurisdiction                | Legislation / Policy Change                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Affected Sector(s)                                               | Net Impact & Strategic Outlook                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Local — Pakistan            | <a href="#">IMF mission for 4th EFF / 2nd RSF review</a> due in Islamabad next month — roughly \$1.2bn combined (\$1bn EFF, \$200m RSF) at stake, with tax collection, energy reforms and privatisation progress under scrutiny | Banks, IPPs/Energy, Equities, Sovereign FX                       | <b>Wins:</b> banks and FX reserves if the tranche clears, sovereign risk premium eases. <b>Losses:</b> energy consumers facing tariff/circular-debt conditionality, importers if reform slippage pressures the PKR.                                                                         |
| GCC — Saudi Arabia / OPEC+  | <a href="#">OPEC+ finalises 188,000 bpd September hike</a> , completing the 2023 cuts rollback ahead of an October 4 JMMC review; <a href="#">PIF's 2026-2030 strategy</a> prioritises tourism, travel and entertainment        | Energy, Sovereign wealth, Tourism/Entertainment, Oil-importer FX | <b>Wins:</b> Saudi non-oil diversification plays in tourism, entertainment and sport; producers' near-term revenue as Brent firms toward \$88.5. <b>Losses:</b> oil-importing economies, including Pakistan, facing a heavier import bill as prices hold up despite the added OPEC+ supply. |
| Global — US Federal Reserve | Fed Chair <a href="#">Kevin Warsh keeps a hawkish tone</a> on the 2% inflation target ahead of the September 15-16 FOMC meeting, even as prediction markets price only a roughly 26% hike probability                           | USD, Rates, EM FX (incl. PKR), Equities                          | <b>Wins:</b> EM currencies including the PKR and rate-sensitive equities if the Fed ultimately holds. <b>Losses:</b> risk assets and short-duration yield-seekers if hawkish rhetoric hardens into an actual September hike.                                                                |

### 04 The Day Ahead — KSE-100 Levels & Desk Stance

#### SUPPORT EST.

**180,036**

Thursday's intraday low; deeper support at 179,500 (desk estimate)

#### PIVOT EST.

**180,105**

Thursday's close — last session before the Independence Day holiday

#### RESISTANCE EST.

**180,311**

Wednesday's close; a reclaim opens the path to Thursday's intraday high near 181,434

The PSX reopens today after a three-day break with the tape essentially unchanged from Thursday's 180,104.61 close — Friday's Independence Day holiday means Monday's session carries the accumulated newsflow of a full weekend, from Wall Street's Friday pullback to firmer oil and gold. We read Thursday's 206-point dip as consolidation rather than a reversal: breadth was negative and fertiliser/pharma saw profit-taking, but oil & gas exploration and cement held firm, and the index remains within 1% of its multi-day highs. A close back above 180,311 would reopen the path toward Thursday's 181,434 intraday high; a slip below 180,036 would point to a retest of 179,500. With Brent holding near \$88.5 and Fed Chair Warsh maintaining a hawkish tone into the September 15-16 FOMC, oil & gas exploration, cement and commercial banks are the counters to watch for the reopen's directional cue. All levels are indicative desk estimates, not recommendations.

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